GRADE 4

Curriculum Book

Businesses need a simple plan

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 4 - Curriculum Book

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Ten fully fleshed lessons spanning the year. *Each lesson is built to pass the picks-up-Monday test: a teacher with no prior prep should be able to read this Sunday night and teach it Monday morning. Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Differentiation is specific and actionable. Vocabulary is included for each lesson. Time blocks default to 50 minutes (one upper-elementary period) unless flagged otherwise.*

Lessons are sampled across the year so the full arc is visible:

1. (Week 1) Cash V1 launch — What is a plan, and why bother?
2. (Week 4) Reading a Real Business — the 3–5 sentence profile
3. (Week 8) Profile Studio Day — Checkpoint 1
4. (Week 11) The 5-Question Reality Check
5. (Week 14) The One-Sentence Customer Statement
6. (Week 21) The $50 Cap — Building an event budget
7. (Week 24) Honest vs. Sketchy — three rules for a kid-run business
8. (Week 29) The 5-Minute Team Meeting (3-item agenda)
9. (Week 32) Before/After — revising a plan with three changes
10. (Week 36) The One-Page Plan Defense

Five answers, one page

The whole plan fits on one sheet of paper.

Lesson 1 — What is a plan, and why bother?

"*A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one.*"

- CASH, GRADE 4

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Read a real business **Topic area:** Year launch · plans as written thinking

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Define a "plan" in their own words as "thinking written down."
- Identify two situations where having a plan would have helped a fictional kid avoid a problem.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-3:** Outline a plan for buying a needed or wanted item — extended at G4 to a small business plan.
- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognizing what you know and don't know.

Materials

- Cash Video #1 ("What is a plan?") — 2:45. (If no projector, read the printed transcript aloud.)
- One Capstone Journal (notebook) per student.
- Two index cards per student.
- A class-sized chart paper labeled "A plan is..." with three blank lines.
- Two short story prompts printed (provided in Activity Book): "The Bake Sale With No Buckets" and "The Dog-Walking Business With No Map."

Vocabulary

- **Plan** — your thinking, written down where you can see it and fix it.
- **Idea** — what you'd like to do. An idea is not yet a plan.
- **Customer** — a real person who would use what you make or do.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video + One Question (~7 min)

Play Cash Video #1. As students watch, post the prompt on the board:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*Have you ever started something — a project, a game, a chore — and halfway through realized you forgot a thing you needed?*"

Pair-share for two minutes. Cold-call two students to share. You're surfacing the everyday human experience that a plan would have caught.

2. Explore — Two Bad Stories (~13 min)

Read the two short story prompts aloud or pass them out:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> ***Story 1.*** *Maya planned a bake sale. She made cookies. She set them up on a table outside the school. Lots of customers came. Then she realized she had no way to make change. People had ten-dollar bills. Her cookies were one dollar. She lost twelve customers in twenty minutes.*
> ***Story 2.*** *Jordan started a dog-walking business. Three neighbors hired him for the same Saturday at the same time. Jordan promised he'd take all three dogs. He didn't think about how to walk three dogs at once. One dog got loose. Jordan's mom had to help.*

Pair-share: "*What's one thing each kid forgot to think about?*" Two pairs share each story. Capture answers on the board. Don't correct — let students notice.

Surface: in both cases, the kid had a good idea. The kid had real customers. What they didn't have was their thinking written down where they could check it. That's what a plan does.

3. Explain — A Plan Is Just Thinking Written Down (~7 min)

Define plan and idea on the board. Write both definitions on the chart paper.

State the year's norm: "*This year, every business idea will get written down. We'll put a customer next to it. A price next to it. A cost next to it. When we write it down, we can see what's missing. That's the whole point.*"

Add to Vocabulary Spine.

4. Apply — Your "I'm Curious About" Sentence (~15 min)

In the Capstone Journal, students write three things:

1. **One kind of business they're curious about.** Just one sentence. Examples: *I'm curious about a backyard car wash. I'm curious about selling friendship bracelets. I'm curious about a math tutoring service for second graders.*

2. **One thing a customer might want from this business.** One sentence.
3. **One thing they don't yet know about this business.**

Confer with five students while others write. Read their sentence; ask one sharpening question: "*Who's the customer?*" or "*What does it cost?*"

5. Close — Pin and Predict (~8 min)

Each student writes their "I'm curious about" sentence on an index card with their name. Collect them.

Tell them: "*I'll hand these back in Week 8. By then you'll have read about a real business and started planning your own. We'll see how this Day 1 idea changed.*"

Final exit prompt:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*On a scale of 1 to 5, how confident are you that your idea is a good one? Write the number on the back of the card.*"

Collect cards. End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide the sentence frame on a sticky note: "*I'm curious about* _ ***for who needs*** __." Allow native-language brainstorming with a peer; require English on the index card. Pre-teach *plan* and *idea* with cognates (Spanish: *plan*, *idea*).
- **IEP/504:** Allow a verbal version recorded on phone or tablet. Provide a printed version of both stories so students can follow along. Extended writing time for the journal entry — okay to finish in the next session.
- **Advanced learners:** Push for specificity in the "kind of business." Ask: "*What's one number you'd need to know? What's one thing only certain customers would want?*" Have them add a fourth line: *one rule the business would have to follow*.

Assessment

Formative: Watch the pair-share for participation; read journal entries during conferring. **Summative:** Day 1 "I'm curious about" card is filed; will be returned in Week 8 alongside the Real-Business Profile.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Read the page in the Student Activity Book titled *What's a plan?* — three short examples — and circle the one that feels most like the kind of plan you'd want to make.

Teacher notes

- Some students will not have a "kind of business" at the end of this lesson. That is fine. They're allowed to write *I'm curious about something but I don't know what yet*. They'll lock in by Week 8.
- A student says "*I have a lot of ideas, I can't pick one.*" Coach: "*Write all of them. Circle the one you'd actually do this Saturday if your friends helped.*" The "this Saturday" frame is concrete.
- This lesson is the year's foundation. If a student finishes the lesson believing a plan is a worksheet, you've underdelivered. The line is *thinking written down*. Repeat it.

Lesson 2 — Reading a Real Business: the 3–5 sentence profile

TRY THIS

One question, five people

Pick the customer question from your one-page plan. Ask five real people in one day. Write each answer in one sentence.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Read a real business **Topic area:** Business awareness · summary writing

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Read or watch a short business profile and identify three pieces of information: what the business does, who it helps, and how it makes money.
- Write a 3–5 sentence summary in their own words.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **CCSS-ELA RI.4.2:** Determine the main idea of a text and explain how it is supported by key details; summarize the text.
- **C3 D2.Eco.4.3-5:** Explain why incentives vary between buyers and sellers.

Materials

- One printed 1-page profile of a real local business (provided in program assets — suggested: a neighborhood bakery). Teachers may substitute a business local to their school.
- Capstone Journal.
- A "What does it do? / Who does it help? / How does it make money?" three-column chart projected.
- Highlighter (one per student).

Vocabulary

- **Business** — a person or group that makes something or does something for customers in exchange for money.
- **Customer** — a person who chooses to give money in exchange for what the business makes or does.

- **Profile** — a short description of who or what something is.
- **Summary** — your own words version, shorter than the original, with the most important parts.

Procedure

1. Engage — Read Aloud the Profile (~10 min)

Read the 1-page profile aloud. The profile should describe a real or realistic local business: what they sell or do, who they sell to, what makes them different. Sample profile (substitute as needed):

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *Ana's Bakery has been on Forest Avenue for twelve years. Ana bakes bread and pastries every morning starting at 5 a.m. Most of her customers come from the neighborhood — parents on the way to work, kids walking home from school, and the office workers next door who buy lunch. Ana sells about 80 loaves of bread a day at $5 each, and 200 pastries at $2 each. Her costs are flour, butter, sugar, the rent on her shop, and her assistant's wages. After all that, she has enough left over to pay herself, save a little, and reinvest in better ovens.*

Don't translate or paraphrase yet. Just read it.

2. Explore — Three Highlighter Passes (~12 min)

Pass out a highlighter. Have students re-read the profile to themselves three times. Each time, they're hunting for one thing:

- **Pass 1:** Highlight what the business does. (Verbs and products.)
- **Pass 2:** Underline who it helps. (Customers.)
- **Pass 3:** Circle how it makes money. (Numbers.)

After each pass, two volunteers share what they highlighted. Capture their answers in the three-column chart on the board.

3. Explain — The Three Questions (~5 min)

Define the three questions a business profile always answers:

1. **What does it do?** (The product or service.)
2. **Who does it help?** (The customer.)
3. **How does it make money?** (Revenue minus costs.)

Surface the rule: "*If you can answer those three questions in three sentences, you understand the business. If you can't, you don't yet.*"

4. Apply — Write Your Own 3–5 Sentence Summary (~15 min)

Students write a 3–5 sentence summary in the Capstone Journal. The summary must include all three answers.

Sentence frames provided for ELL and any student who needs them:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*_ is a business that _. Their customers are _. They make money by _. The thing that makes them different is __.*"

Confer with as many students as possible.

5. Close — Two Volunteers Read (~8 min)

Two volunteers read their summary aloud. Class listens for the three answers. Cold-call two students: "*Did you hear what the business does? Who it helps? How it makes money?*"

End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide the sentence frame above on a printed card. Allow native-language reading partner if available. Pre-teach *profile* and *summary* with cognates (Spanish: *perfil*, *resumen*).
- **IEP/504:** Pre-highlight a "model" version of the profile so students can see what each color is for. Reduce to 3 sentences if 5 is overwhelming. Allow voice-recorded summary.

- **Advanced learners:** Add a fourth question: "*What's one thing you'd ask Ana if you could?*" Have them write the question in their journal. This previews the customer interview unit in Grade 7.

Assessment

Formative: Watch the highlighter passes; check that students aren't highlighting wholesale. Read summaries during conferring. **Summative:** The 3–5 sentence summary feeds the Real-Business Profile checkpoint at Week 8.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Find one real business in your neighborhood. Walk past it (or look it up online with a parent). Bring the name, what it does, and one guess about who its customers are to Friday's class.

Teacher notes

- Some students will write "*Ana is a person who makes bread.*" That's a person, not a business. Coach: "*What does the business do, not just Ana?*"
- A student writes a long summary copying full sentences from the profile. Coach: "*In your own words. Pretend you're telling your sibling who Ana is.*"
- The "how it makes money" question is the new one for many students. Be patient. By Unit 3 it'll be second nature.

Lesson 3 — Profile Studio Day (Checkpoint 1)

WORDS TO KNOW

Plan
Five honest answers about how a business works.

Customer
The exact person you can name and describe.

Offer
What the customer gets, in plain words.

Pricing
What the customer pays, and why that number.

Test
The smallest real thing you can do to see if the plan works.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 80 minutes (block — Checkpoint day) **Unit:** 1 — Read a real business **Topic area:** Business awareness · summary · transition to own idea

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Submit a final 3–5 sentence Real-Business Profile that names what the business does, who it helps, and how it makes money.
- Draft a one-sentence "Capstone Topic" — the kind of business they will plan across the year.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4 and W.4.5:** Produce clear and coherent writing; develop and strengthen writing through revising.
- **CCSS-ELA RI.4.2:** Determine main idea and summarize.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1:** Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.

Materials

- Each student's draft Real-Business Profile (from Week 6 work).
- Real-Business Profile rubric (Rubric 1 simplified for G4 — Customer clarity, Value proposition, Financial logic, Communication).
- Day 1 "I'm curious about" cards (returned).
- Capstone Journal.
- Wall space for the Profile Gallery.
- Sticky notes (3 colors).

Vocabulary

(All previously introduced — recycle.) Reinforce: *business, customer, profile, summary.*

Procedure

1. Engage — Hand Back Day 1 Cards (~7 min)

Hand back the Day 1 "I'm curious about" cards. Quietly. Ask students to read their own and write one sentence in the Capstone Journal:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*On Day 1 I was curious about* ***__. After reading a real business, here's what I notice about my idea:*** *____.*"

2. Revise the Profile (~25 min)

Students take their draft Real-Business Profile and revise it against the rubric. Project the four criteria on the board:

- **Customer clarity** — Does your profile name a specific customer (not "everybody")?
- **Value proposition** — Does it say what the business does, for whom?
- **Financial logic** — Does it name how the business makes money (with at least one number)?
- **Communication** — Is it 3–5 sentences and clear to read?

Students self-score Draft 1 (1–4 on each criterion), then revise. Confer with each student for 2–3 minutes.

3. Write the Capstone Topic Line (~15 min)

Mini-lesson: now that they've read a real business, students draft a one-sentence Capstone Topic — the kind of business they'll plan for the rest of the year.

Sentence frame:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*My Capstone is a _ for _ who need __.*"

Examples (project on board):

- *My Capstone is a backyard car wash for neighbors who need their car cleaned but don't have time on weekends.*
- *My Capstone is friendship bracelets for fifth graders who like to give birthday gifts.*
- *My Capstone is a math tutoring service for second graders who struggle with addition.*

Each student drafts their own. Revise with a partner. Final version goes in the Capstone Journal as Page 1.

4. Profile Gallery Walk (~15 min)

Tape Real-Business Profiles to the wall. Students walk in silence for 5 minutes, leaving sticky-note feedback in two colors:

- **Yellow sticky:** "*I see…*" (specific noticing — what works)
- **Blue sticky:** "*I wonder…*" (a question that would sharpen the profile)

Then 3 students share their profile aloud (1 minute each). Use the rubric criteria as listening structure.

5. Submit (~8 min)

Real-Business Profiles are submitted (digital or paper) for grading using the simplified Business Plan rubric (Rubric 1, Grade 4–5 setting).

6. Close (~10 min)

Final journal entry:

> CASH SAYS
>
> "*My Capstone Topic is* ***__. The thing I most need to figure out next is*** *____*."

End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide the Capstone Topic sentence frame on a printed card. Sentence frames for the gallery sticky notes ("I see that…"). Allow oral defense in pair-share if whole-class share is uncomfortable.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-fill student name and date on the rubric self-score sheet. Chunk the worksheet to one criterion per page. Extended time — finish next class period if needed. Allow audio submission of the Capstone Topic line.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what makes my Capstone different from the real business I read about?" sentence. Push for specificity in the customer line — not "kids," but "third graders on Tuesdays at recess." This previews Grade 5 segmentation.

Assessment

Summative: The Real-Business Profile is graded on the simplified Rubric 1 (4 criteria). Anchor papers from prior years (or instructor-built exemplars) calibrate scoring.

Closure

Same as #6.

Homework / Extension

Capstone Journal entry: "*What's one question I want to ask a real customer about my Capstone idea?*"

Teacher notes

- Some students will struggle to lock a Capstone Topic. They're allowed to switch in Week 9 (the optional pivot window). Don't push too hard. A vague Topic now is better than a topic the student doesn't believe in.
- A student writes a Capstone Topic that's clearly impractical (e.g., *a video game company*). Coach toward *something they could actually try in the next year*. Re-read the Capstone-friendly categories: food, tutoring, content, service, repair, events.
- The gallery walk is high-leverage; protect the time. Even if conferring runs long, do all 3 share-outs.

Lesson 4 — The 5-Question Reality Check

> **MATH MOMENT**
>
> **How many a week?**
>
> If you sold 3 a day for 5 days, how many is that? If each one costs $2 to make and sells for $5, what's left?

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (block, or 2 × 30-min) **Unit:** 2 — The Reality Check **Topic area:** Idea testing · multistep math

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Run their Capstone idea through the 5-question Reality Check, writing reasonable estimates for each.

- Identify which of their five answers they're least sure about and explain why.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-3:** Apply the steps of a decision-making process.
- **CCSS-Math 4.OA.A.3:** Solve multistep word problems with whole numbers.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2:** Generate and compare multiple possible solutions to a problem.

Materials

- The 5-Question Reality Check template (provided — one per student).
- Capstone Journal.
- A worked example projected (the "lemonade stand" Reality Check).
- Calculator (allowed).

Vocabulary

- **Estimate** — your best guess at a number, based on what you know.
- **Reasonable** — a guess that makes sense given what's true. ("My lemonade stand sells 1,000 cups a day" is not reasonable. "10 cups a day on a hot Saturday" probably is.)
- **Reality Check** — five questions you ask any idea before you trust it.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video #2 (~5 min)

Play Cash Video #2 ("The 5-Question Reality Check"). Cash walks through the five questions on a fictional kid's car-wash idea. Students don't take notes — they listen.

2. Explain — The Five Questions (~10 min)

Project the five questions on the board:

1. **Who buys?** (Who is your customer? Be specific.)
2. **How much?** (What's the price for one customer?)
3. **How many?** (How many customers in a day, week, or month?)
4. **What does it cost me?** (What do you spend per customer to make or serve it?)
5. **What's left?** (Money in minus money out.)

Walk through the lemonade-stand example out loud:

- **Who buys?** *Neighbors and parents walking by my house on a Saturday afternoon.*
- **How much?** *$1.00 per cup.*
- **How many?** *I think 15 cups in 3 hours, on a sunny Saturday.*
- **What does it cost me?** *Lemons, sugar, water, cups. About $0.30 per cup.*
- **What's left?** *Revenue: 15 × $1 = $15. Cost: 15 × $0.30 = $4.50. Left over: $10.50.*

Surface the rule: *every question has to have a real number or a real customer in it. "Lots of people" is not an answer to How many. "10 people" is.*

3. We do — One Together (~15 min)

Together, work a second example: a friendship-bracelet business. Take answers from the class, write them on the board.

- **Who buys?** Get specific. Push past "kids." Land on something like *fourth graders who give birthday presents to their friends.*
- **How much?** Take a vote. Probably $2–$5.
- **How many?** Per month? Per week? Land on a reasonable number.

- **What does it cost me?** Walk through cord, beads, time. Land on something like $0.30 per bracelet.
- **What's left?** Compute revenue minus cost. Make the math visible.

If revenue minus cost is negative or tiny, say so out loud. Coach: "*At this price, the bracelet business doesn't really work. What would have to change?*" Two students share. Don't fix it for them — let them sit with the math.

4. You do — Apply to Capstone (~20 min)

Students fill in the 5-Question Reality Check template for *their own* Capstone idea. Confer with as many as possible. Common stuck points:

- "*I don't know how many.*" Coach: "*Make a guess. Use your week — how many bracelets could you actually make in a week?*"
- "*My cost is zero because my mom buys the supplies.*" Coach: "*The math of the business doesn't care who pays. If you ran this for real, you'd buy them. What would they cost?*"
- "*What's left is negative.*" Validate: "*Then the price is too low or the cost is too high. What would you change?*"

5. Close — Pick Your Least Sure (~10 min)

In the Capstone Journal, students write:

- *The question I'm least sure about is _____.*
- *Here's why I'm not sure: _____.*
- *One way I could check: _____.*

Two volunteers share. End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide a printed reference card with the five questions and a worked lemonade example. Cognates: Spanish *cliente, precio, costo, ganancia*. Sentence frames for the journal entry.

- **IEP/504:** Calculator allowed. Reduce the questions from 5 to 4 if overwhelming (drop "What's left?" and compute it together at the end). Pre-printed template with example numbers.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what if" twist — what happens to "What's left?" if the price drops 25%? If the cost rises 20%? Compute both. This previews Grade 5's pricing-with-margin work.

Assessment

Formative: Worksheet performance during the You do; conferring on Capstone application. **Summative:** The 5-Question Reality Check is part of the Reality Check Pack at Checkpoint 2 (Week 18).

Closure

Exit ticket: "*Reasonable estimates beat made-up estimates because _____.*" One sentence.

Homework / Extension

Capstone Journal: write one way you could check your "least sure" answer this week. (Asking a friend, asking a parent, looking up the price of supplies, counting how many you could actually make.)

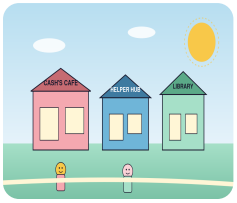
Teacher notes

- A student writes "1 million customers." Coach gently: "*Could you serve 1 million customers? What's the most you've ever served — friends, classmates? Start there.*"
- The "What's left?" line is the year's first profit calculation. Some students will be excited; some will be deflated by the small number. Both reactions are useful. Cash's frame: *that's the math. The math is not your enemy. The math tells you what to fix.*
- This lesson is the engine of Unit 2. Don't skip the "We do" together example — it's where the math gets unstuck for most students.

Lesson 5 — The One-Sentence Customer Statement

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real answers

Read each plan answer to a different person. Write what they say back, exactly. That's data.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 2 — The Reality Check **Topic area:** Customer awareness · clear writing

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Write a one-sentence customer statement using the format "*This is for [who] who needs [what].*"
- Distinguish between a vague customer ("everybody," "kids") and a specific customer ("third graders on Tuesday afternoons who play kickball").

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **C3 D2.Eco.4.3-5:** Explain why incentives vary between buyers and sellers.
- **CASEL Social Awareness:** Perspective-taking — noticing whose needs you're talking about.

Materials

- The Customer Statement worksheet (provided).
- Capstone Journal.
- Three short example "before/after" customer statements projected.
- Sticky notes (1 color).

Vocabulary

- **Customer statement** — one sentence that names exactly who your business is for and what they need.
- **Specific** — clear about who and what. The opposite of vague.
- **Vague** — fuzzy, unclear. "Kids" is vague; "third graders who play kickball at recess" is specific.

Procedure

1. Engage — Three Before/Afters (~10 min)

Project three "before" customer statements and three "after" versions:

BEFORE (VAGUE)	AFTER (SPECIFIC)
"This is for kids."	"This is for third graders who get hungry between recess and lunch."
"This is for people who like bracelets."	"This is for fourth graders who buy birthday gifts under $5."
"This is for everybody."	"This is for parents in our neighborhood who don't have time to wash their car on weekends."

Pair-share: "*What's the difference between the before and the after?*" Two pairs share. Surface: the after sentences name an *age*, a *moment*, and a *need*. The before sentences don't.

2. Explain — The Format (~5 min)

Define the customer statement format:

> **CASH SAYS**
> "*This is for [WHO] who needs [WHAT].*"

WHO has to include at least one of: an age, a place, a moment, or a habit. WHAT has to be a specific need or frustration.

Cash's question: "*Who is this for, exactly? You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

3. Apply — Draft Yours (~15 min)

Students draft a customer statement for their Capstone in the Capstone Journal. They write three drafts on three sticky notes:

- Sticky 1: a vague version (the kind they might write without thinking).
- Sticky 2: a more specific version.
- Sticky 3: their best version.

Put all three on a Journal page side by side.

Confer with as many as possible. Common stuck points:

- "*My customer is kids.*" Coach: *Which kids? What grade? Where? When?*
- "*My customer is everybody who likes [my product].*" Coach: *That's a wish, not a customer. Who's the first person who'd actually pay you?*

4. Partner Check (~10 min)

Pair up. Each student reads their best customer statement to their partner. Partner asks two questions:

1. *Could you point to a real person who matches this customer?*
2. *Is the need something the customer would say, or just something we wish?*

Revise based on partner feedback.

5. Close — Wall of Customers (~10 min)

Each student writes their final customer statement on a sticky note and posts it to a class chart titled "Our Customers." Two volunteers share. Class quickly notices: are most of them specific? Are some still vague? Two pairs offer one improvement to a vague one, with permission.

End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide the sentence frame on a printed card. Cognates: Spanish *cliente, específico*. Allow native-language drafting; require English on the final sticky.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce the three drafts to two (vague and specific). Pre-printed sticky notes with the frame. Pair with a strong English speaker for the partner check.
- **Advanced learners:** Push for a *not for* line: "*This is not for* __ ***because*** ____." This previews Grade 5 segmentation. Have them write a second customer statement for a different segment of the same product.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during drafting; check that "specific" really means specific. Read the partner-check revisions. **Summative:** The customer statement is part of the Reality Check Pack at Checkpoint 2 (Week 18) and the One-Page Plan at Checkpoint 4 (Week 36).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Capstone Journal: write one thing you'd want to ask your customer if you had 30 seconds with them.

Teacher notes

- A student picks a customer that's clearly themselves. ("*This is for me, because I want one.*") Coach: *Are there other people who'd want what you want? Who? How would you find them?*
- A student writes a vague customer and defends it. "*But everyone would want my candy!*" Cash's move: "*Maybe. But who's the first person? The one you could literally walk up to today and sell to?*"
- The Wall of Customers stays up through the year. Reference it in later lessons.

Lesson 6 — The $50 Cap: Building an event budget

FAMILY TALK

Five honest answers

Read your one-page plan to a family member. Ask: 'Which answer sounds the least real to you, and why?' Listen, don't defend.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (block) **Unit:** 3 — The $50 Plan **Topic area:** Budgeting · multistep money math · trade-offs

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Build a 1-page budget for a hypothetical classroom event with at least 4 categories that does not exceed a $50 cap.
- Identify and document one trade-off they had to make to fit under the cap.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math 4.MD.A.2:** Use the four operations to solve word problems involving money.
- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-3:** Outline a plan for buying a needed or wanted item.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4:** Planning for spending can help people make informed choices.

Materials

- The $50 Event Budget template (provided — printed, one per student).
- Calculator (allowed).
- A reference sheet with sample prices (cups: $0.05 each; juice boxes: $0.50 each; balloons: $0.10 each; markers: $0.25 each; poster paper: $1 each; small prizes: $0.50 each; etc.). Provided in program assets.
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Budget** — a written plan for how you'll spend money, with a total you don't go over.
- **Cap** — the most you're allowed to spend. ("*The cap is $50.*")
- **Category** — a group of things in a budget. (*Snacks. Decorations. Supplies. Prizes.*)
- **Subtotal** — the total for one category.
- **Total** — all the subtotals added up.
- **Trade-off** — when you can't have both, so you pick. ("*More cups means fewer prizes.*")

Procedure

1. Engage — The Story of Maya's Bake Sale (~7 min)

Read aloud:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *Maya is planning a Game Day for her fourth-grade class — 25 students. She has $50 from the school. She wants snacks, decorations, supplies for board games, and small prizes for the winners. She makes a list and adds it up. Total: $63. She has $50. What does Maya cut?*

Pair-share: "*What's one thing you'd cut, and why?*" Two pairs share. Capture answers on the board.

Surface: every budget hits this moment. The work isn't picking what you want — it's picking what to leave out.

2. Explain — The Template (~8 min)

Project the $50 Event Budget template. It has four columns:

| Category | Item | Quantity | Subtotal |

And rows for at least 4 categories (snacks, decorations, supplies, prizes — or whatever fits the event). At the bottom: a TOTAL row and the words "*Cap: $50.*"

Walk through one row together:

- Category: Snacks.
- Item: Juice boxes.
- Quantity: 25.
- Subtotal: 25 × $0.50 = $12.50.

Surface the math rule: *quantity* × *price* = *subtotal*. Then *all subtotals* = *total*.

3. Apply — Build Your Budget (~30 min)

Each student builds a budget for one of these classroom events (pick one — don't pick a meal-based event, see Sensitivity in the Curriculum Book):

- Class Game Day (board games, prizes, decorations)

- Class Craft Afternoon (paper, markers, glue, small prizes)
- Class Read-Aloud Day (cozy decorations, bookmarks, small prizes for trivia)

Students use the price reference sheet. They must:

- Have at least 4 categories.
- Stay under $50.
- Show the subtotal math for each row.
- Show the total at the bottom.

Confer with as many as possible. Common stuck points:

- "*I'm at $63 and I don't know what to cut.*" Coach: *Look at your subtotals. Which category is biggest? Cut from there first. What can you do without?*
- "*My math is wrong.*" Walk through one row. Most errors are quantity × price.
- "*I want everything to be $50 exactly.*" It's fine to be under. Most professional budgets are. Save the difference.

4. Close — The Trade-Off Sentence (~10 min)

In the Capstone Journal, students write one sentence:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*To stay under $50, I had to* ***__ instead of _, because*** *___.*"

Two volunteers share. End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide a printed reference card with the math rule (*quantity* × *price* = *subtotal*) and cognates (*presupuesto, total, categoría*). Allow a partner to help with the multiplication if needed; require independent total.

- **IEP/504:** Calculator allowed throughout. Reduce category requirement from 4 to 3 if overwhelmed; add the 4th in conferring time. Pre-printed template with example rows already filled in as models.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what if my cap is $40" version — re-do the budget with $10 less. What did you cut differently? Then a "what if my cap is $75" version — what did you add? This sets up Grade 5 sensitivity analysis.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during the build; spot-check subtotal math. Confer on the trade-off sentence. **Summative:** The $50 Event Budget is the Checkpoint 3 anchor artifact (Week 28). Graded on Rubric 3 (Budget) at the simplified Grade 4 setting (4 criteria).

Closure

Same as #4.

Homework / Extension

Find one real receipt at home (a school book fair receipt, a snack receipt, anything). With a parent's permission, copy the categories and totals into your journal. Don't share dollar amounts that feel private. Just notice: how many categories?

Teacher notes

- The Sensitivity flag: NEVER ask students to budget a meal, a grocery trip, or a household activity. The classroom-event framing is non-negotiable.
- A student wants to use real prices from a real store. Allow it if they can find them (with adult help). Real prices are great. Just check the math.
- This lesson is the year's most math-heavy. Some students will need a second pass on Wednesday. Plan for it.

Lesson 7 — Honest vs. Sketchy: three rules for a kid-run business

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 3 — The $50 Plan (cross-cuts ESL strand) **Topic area:** Ethics · safety · honesty in claims

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- List three rules a kid-run business should follow (honesty about ingredients, safety with food, asking adult permission, age limits on labor).
- Pick one rule as the most important and defend the choice with a written reason.

Standards alignment

- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Ethical responsibility.
- **CCSS-ELA W.4.1:** Write opinion pieces, supporting a point of view with reasons.
- **C3 D2.Civ.7.3-5:** Apply civic virtues and democratic principles in school settings.

Materials

- Two sample product labels (provided, one clear and honest, one vague — e.g., a cookie label that says "100% chocolate chip cookie, made with butter, sugar, flour, eggs, milk" vs. a cookie label that says "All natural treats, mom-approved!").

- Four short scenario cards (provided in Activity Book).
- Capstone Journal.
- Class chart paper labeled "Three Rules for a Kid-Run Business."

Vocabulary

- **Honest** — telling what's true, even when it's not flattering.
- **Sketchy** — a little bit not-honest, or hiding something.
- **Ingredient** — what's actually in something.
- **Permission** — asking before you do something that affects other people.

Procedure

1. Engage — Two Cookie Labels (~10 min)

Project the two cookie labels side by side:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> ***Label A:*** *Sarah's Cookies. Ingredients: butter, sugar, flour, eggs, chocolate chips, vanilla. Made in my kitchen with my mom's help. May contain peanuts (we use peanut butter sometimes).*
> ***Label B:*** *Sarah's Awesome Treats! All-natural, mom-approved, the best cookies in school! Eat as many as you want!*

Pair-share: "*Which one would you trust more? Why?*" Two pairs share. Surface: Label A names ingredients (including a warning). Label B uses big words but says nothing specific. Label A is honest. Label B is sketchy.

2. Explain — Four Possible Rules (~10 min)

Project four rules on the board:

1. **Honesty about ingredients.** If you're selling food, say what's in it. Don't hide allergens.
2. **Safety with food.** Wash hands. Use clean tools. Keep things cold that need to be cold.

3. **Asking adult permission.** Get a parent's or teacher's okay before you sell at school or in your neighborhood.
4. **Age limits on labor.** Some jobs are not for kids. (Cooking with hot oil. Using power tools. Things that need a license.)

Discuss each briefly. Tell students they'll pick three to make their own list.

3. Apply — Pick Three, Pick One (~15 min)

In the Capstone Journal, each student writes:

- *My three rules for a kid-run business are* ***_,*** *_, and ____.*
- *The most important rule is* ***_ because _****.*

Confer with as many as possible. Push for specific reasons. Generic "*because it's good*" should become "*because if you don't say what's in your cookies, somebody with a peanut allergy could get sick.*"

4. Scenario Sort (~10 min)

Pass out four short scenario cards in pairs:

- A kid sells lemonade at a park. They don't tell customers the lemonade is from a powder packet, not from real lemons.
- A kid makes friendship bracelets. The customer asks if they can return one if it breaks. The kid says yes, then doesn't refund.
- A kid sells homemade granola bars at school. The kid forgot to wash hands. A customer gets sick.
- A 9-year-old advertises a "house-cleaning service" online without telling parents.

In pairs, students decide: *honest, sketchy, unsafe,* or *not allowed at this age*. Two pairs share. Discuss.

5. Close — One Sentence Pledge (~5 min)

In the Capstone Journal, each student writes:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*In my Capstone, I will follow this rule:* ***__. I'm picking it because ____.***"

End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide a printed glossary for the four rules. Cognates (*honesto, permiso, seguridad*). Allow native-language pledge with English summary.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce scenarios from 4 to 2. Allow verbal pledge. Provide pre-printed sentence frames.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a fifth rule of their own invention. Defend it. Then a "what if my friend wanted me to break this rule" scenario — what would they do?

Assessment

Formative: Walk during scenario discussion. Read pledges in conferring.
Summative: The pledge is part of the One-Page Plan at Checkpoint 4 (Week 36).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Find one real label at home (a snack package, a drink bottle). Look for the ingredient list. Bring a sentence about what you noticed.

Teacher notes

- This lesson can surface allergy stories. Be ready. Validate; don't probe.
- A student says "*my rule is to not sell to mean kids.*" That's not a business rule, that's a friendship rule. Coach back to the ethics frame.

- Don't moralize about the sketchy label. The point is what's *useful* (honest claims build customers who come back) — not what's *good*. Cash's frame: *honest claims are good business, and they happen to be honest.*

Lesson 8 — The 5-Minute Team Meeting (3-item agenda)

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 4 — The One-Page Plan defense
Topic area: Leadership · teamwork · running a meeting

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Run a 5-minute team meeting with a 3-item agenda (last week, this week, blockers).
- Take notes during a meeting and identify one blocker that needs follow-up.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA SL.4.1:** Engage effectively in collaborative discussions.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Communication, teamwork.
- **C3 D2.Civ.10.3-5:** Identify the beliefs, experiences, perspectives, and values that underlie their own and others' points of view.

Materials

- The 3-Item Agenda template (provided): Last week / This week / Blockers.
- Timer (visible to all).
- Capstone Journal.
- Class chart with "What a meeting needs" (blank — fills in during lesson).

Vocabulary

- **Agenda** — the list of things you're going to talk about, in order, with a time for each.
- **Blocker** — something stopping you from getting your work done. ("I can't make bracelets because I'm out of cord" is a blocker.)
- **Role** — what each person is supposed to do at the meeting (timekeeper, note-taker, facilitator).

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video #5 (~5 min)

Play Cash Video #5 ("The 5-Minute Team Meeting"). Cash shows a kid running a 5-minute meeting for a 3-person team — last week, this week, blockers — with a timer on the table.

2. Explain — The 3-Item Agenda (~7 min)

Project the agenda template:

ITEM	TIME	NOTES
1. Last week — what got done?	1 min	
2. This week — what's the plan?	2 min	
3. Blockers — what's stuck?	2 min	

Walk through each item. Surface the rule: *every item has a time. The timer is a real thing on the table. When the time is up, you move on, even if you're not done. You can come back to it after.*

Then surface the three roles:

- **Facilitator** — runs the agenda. Keeps the meeting moving.
- **Timekeeper** — watches the clock. Says "30 seconds" before each item ends.

- **Note-taker** — writes down what got decided and what blockers came up.

3. We do — A Demo Meeting (~10 min)

Pull three volunteers to the front for a demo meeting. Give them a fictional team scenario (provided): three classmates running a friendship-bracelet business who need to talk about what got made last week, what's planned for this week, and one blocker (running low on red cord).

Run the meeting in front of the class with the visible timer. Don't fix mistakes — let students notice. After 5 minutes (real time), debrief:

- What worked?
- What got skipped?
- What did the timer change?

4. You do — Run Your Own Meetings (~20 min)

Form 3-person teams (or use existing Capstone teams if students are paired with classmates). Each team will run their own 5-minute meeting using the agenda template, on their actual Capstones. Rotate roles every 5 minutes so each student plays each role at least once.

Total: 15 minutes for 3 rotations.

Confer with as many teams as possible. Watch for: are they staying on time? Is the note-taker actually writing? Is the facilitator moving things along?

5. Close — Blocker Share-Out (~8 min)

Each team shares one blocker that came up in their meeting. Class brainstorms one possible solution per blocker (briefly — 30 seconds each). Capture solutions on chart paper.

End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide the agenda template with sentence frames. Cognates (*agenda*). Allow note-taking in native language; share-out in English with a peer's help.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce meeting time from 5 minutes to 3 minutes if overwhelming. Permit one role only (e.g., note-taker). Pre-printed agenda with one row per item.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a fourth agenda item: *Decisions* — what got decided this meeting? Push toward concise, clear decision statements ("We will buy 50 cords by Friday").

Assessment

Formative: Watch teams run meetings. Read note-taker notes.
Summative: Team meetings continue weekly across Unit 4. The Week 36 defense includes a "what blocker did I solve?" question.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Capstone Journal: *write one blocker on your Capstone and one thing you could try this week to unblock it.*

Teacher notes

- A team will go over time on Item 1 ("Last week") because they want to recap everything. Coach: "*What happened is less important than what's next. Move on.*"
- Some students will be uncomfortable in the facilitator role. Pair them with a strong partner first. By rotation 3, they'll have done it.
- The blocker concept is the breakthrough for many students. They've never named a stuck thing in their work before. Once they have a word for it, they start solving more.

Lesson 9 — Before/After: revising a plan with three changes

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (block) **Unit:** 4 — The One-Page Plan defense **Topic area:** Revision · self-assessment · plan iteration

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Compare a "before" and "after" version of their One-Page Plan.
- Circle three specific changes they made and write a one-sentence reason for each.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.4.5:** Develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, and editing.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-3:** Apply the steps of a decision-making process.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-3:** Plan and carry out fair tests in which variables are controlled and failure points are considered.

Materials

- Each student's Draft 1 of the One-Page Plan (from Week 30 work).
- A blank One-Page Plan template (for Draft 2).
- Three highlighter colors (yellow, blue, pink — used to mark types of changes).

- Capstone Journal.
- Before/After Diff sheet (provided).

Vocabulary

- **Draft** — a version. Draft 1 is the first version. Draft 2 is the revised version.
- **Revise** — to change a draft based on what you learned.
- **Change** — what's different between two drafts.
- **Reason** — why you made the change.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video #7 (~5 min)

Play Cash Video #7 ("A little less wrong, every week"). Cash shows a fictional kid's One-Page Plan with three messy revisions, then a clean Draft 2. Cash reads the three reasons aloud.

2. Explain — Three Kinds of Changes (~7 min)

Surface three kinds of revisions students might make:

- **Yellow change** — the customer changed (you got more specific about who it's for).
- **Blue change** — the math changed (the price, the cost, or the "what's left" got revised).
- **Pink change** — the plan changed (something you'd do differently — the timing, the steps, the materials).

Tell students they will mark Draft 1 with all three colors.

3. Mark Draft 1 (~10 min)

Hand back Draft 1. Each student rereads their Draft 1 and marks places to revise:

- Yellow highlight on anything about the customer.
- Blue highlight on anything about the math.

- Pink highlight on anything about the plan steps.

(Some students will have lots of marks. Some will have few. Both are fine. The marks aren't the point — the *changes* are.)

4. Build Draft 2 (~25 min)

Students transfer the unchanged parts to a fresh One-Page Plan template, and rewrite the parts they want to revise. They are required to make at least 3 changes. The changes can be in any of the three colors, but at least one customer change AND one math change.

Confer with as many students as possible. Common stuck points:

- "*Nothing is wrong with my Draft 1.*" Coach: "*Read it to a partner. Where do they ask a question? That's a place to revise.*"
- "*I want to change everything.*" Coach: "*You can. Just make sure each change has a reason.*"

5. Diff Sheet (~10 min)

Each student fills in the Before/After Diff sheet:

#	WHAT I CHANGED	WHERE (CUSTOMER/MATH/PLAN)	WHY I CHANGED IT
1			
2			
3			

Then circle the three changes on Draft 1 and Draft 2 (so a reader can see them).

6. Close — Pair Share (~3 min)

Pair up. Each student shares their three changes with their partner. Partner asks: "*Which change do you think mattered most? Why?*"

End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide sentence frames for the diff sheet ("I changed ___ because ___"). Cognates (*revisar, cambio, razón*). Allow oral revision discussion before writing.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce the change requirement from 3 to 2. Permit voice-recorded reasons. Pre-marked Draft 1 with revision suggestions noted by the teacher in conferring.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "fourth change" reflection — *what change am I considering but not making yet, and why?* This previews Grade 5 PDSA-style iteration.

Assessment

Formative: Confer during Draft 2 build. Read diff sheets. **Summative:** The Before/After Diff sheet is part of the Capstone defense at Week 36.

Closure

Same as #6.

Homework / Extension

Capstone Journal: *which of your three changes are you proudest of? Why?*

Teacher notes

- A student rewrites Draft 2 to be identical to Draft 1. This usually means they don't see what's wrong yet. Pair with a peer to read aloud. Most issues become visible when read.
- A student's three changes are all cosmetic (handwriting, spelling). Coach toward content: *what does the customer want that you didn't say in Draft 1?*
- Revision is the hardest skill of the year. Be patient. Some students will hit it on Draft 2; others not until Draft 3. Both are fine.

Lesson 10 — The One-Page Plan Defense

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 90 minutes (block, or two periods) **Unit:** Capstone synthesis **Topic area:** Reflection · public presentation · year-long synthesis

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Deliver a 4-minute Capstone Defense covering: (a) the customer they ended with, (b) the price and cost, (c) the budget for one event, (d) the three changes they made between Draft 1 and Draft 2.
- Respond to two panel questions citing specific evidence from their One-Page Plan.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA SL.4.4:** Report on a topic, with appropriate facts and relevant details.
- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-3:** Apply the steps of a decision-making process.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness + Responsible Decision-Making.**

Materials

- Each student's full Capstone Journal.
- Each student's One-Page Plan (Draft 2) and Before/After Diff sheet.
- The Pitch Presentation rubric (Rubric 2 at the Grades 5–6 setting — five criteria, no Q&A criterion).
- Panel of 2–4 evaluators (other teachers, parents, older students, community members).
- Timer.
- The Day 1 "I'm curious about" cards (returned).

Vocabulary

(All previously introduced — recycle.)

Procedure

1. Engage — The 60-Second Warm-Up (~10 min)

Pair students up. Each gives a 60-second "elevator" version of their Capstone to their partner. Partner asks one question. Repeat with a new partner. (Two rounds total.)

2. Set the Norms (~5 min)

State the day's norms:

- Each student gets 4 minutes for the defense + 2 minutes for panel Q&A.
- The panel is curious, not adversarial. They are looking for evidence and revision, not for "is this a great business?"
- The audience listens silently and writes one "*I noticed…*" and one "*I wondered…*" per presenter.

Show the rubric (Pitch, simplified for Grade 5–6 setting). The 5 criteria: Customer + need clarity, Specifics not generalities, Logical flow, Honest claims, Delivery.

3. Defenses (~50 min, ~10–12 students at 6 min each; longer block or split day for more)

Each student delivers the 4-minute defense with this structure:

- **The customer (1 min):** "My customer is [***_]. They want [***_]. Here's the one-sentence statement: _____."
- **The math (1 min):** "My price is [***_]. My cost per customer is [***_]. What's left is [____]. Here's why I priced it where I did."
- **The budget (1 min):** "I budgeted a [event] for $50 with these categories. The trade-off I had to make was [***_] instead of [***_]."
- **The three changes (1 min):** "Between Draft 1 and Draft 2, I changed [1, 2, 3]. The change that mattered most was [***_] because [***_]."

After each: 2 minutes of panel Q&A. Timer enforced.

4. Audience Reflection (~5 min)

Each audience member completes a 2-question card:

- *One thing I noticed across many defenses today: __.*
- *One thing I'd want to learn more about: __.*

Collect.

5. Final Cash Reflection (~10 min)

Play Cash Video #8 — the year-end "Plans Are Just Thinking Written Down" summary. Students write one final Capstone Journal entry:

- *The biggest thing I learned this year was [____].*
- *One thing I'd tell next year's Grade 4 student is [____].*
- *I'm proud of [____].*
- *I'm going to keep working on [____].*

6. Close (~10 min)

Hand back Day 1 "I'm curious about" cards. Students re-read theirs. Two volunteers share what 36 weeks of work did to it.

End class. End year.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Allow visuals to carry more weight in the defense — printed plan, budget poster. Sentence frames for Q&A: "*I think ___ because [evidence].*" Permit a same-language peer to translate panel questions on the spot if needed.
- **IEP/504:** Allow the defense to be delivered in shorter chunks if 4 minutes is overwhelming — 1-minute mini-segments with a 30-second pause. Permit a printed script. Audio-recorded version submitted in advance is also acceptable.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what would I change if I had one more month?" segment. Push for a 1-paragraph written addendum identifying

the highest-leverage next step. Some advanced students may extend toward Grade 5 work — pricing-with-margin, segmentation.

Assessment

Summative: The defense is graded on the simplified Pitch Presentation rubric. The Capstone Journal across the full year is a separate portfolio grade using the Reflection Writing rubric (Grades 3–5 setting, first 3 criteria, 3–5 sentence reflections acceptable).

Closure

Same as #6.

Homework / Extension

(End of year — none required.)

Teacher notes

- Panel members need a 10-minute briefing before defenses start. Cover: rubric, norms, what to ask for evidence, what NOT to ask (no judgments on whether the venture would "really work"; no questions about family money). Provide them with 5 sample questions: "*What was the biggest surprise in your Reality Check? Who was the very first customer you imagined? Walk me through your math one more time. Which change between Draft 1 and Draft 2 mattered most? If you had one more week, what's the first thing you'd fix?*"
- The Day 1 card return at the end is the year's emotional payoff. Don't skip.
- Some students will be very nervous. The 60-second warm-up matters. So does the audience-card structure — it makes peers active listeners, not silent watchers.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 4 worked examples and misconceptions

Worked examples for the budget lesson (add to Lesson 6 — The $50 Cap)

The original lesson teaches the cap concept. Add three full worked examples that show how to fix a budget that overruns.

Worked example A — Overrun by a little ($63 → $48)

Draft 1 budget for a class movie night:

CATEGORY	COST
Popcorn supplies	$20
Drinks	$15
Decorations	$18
Movie rental	$10
Total	**$63** (over by $13)

Coach: "*Where can you cut? Do you need decorations? What if drinks cost $8 instead of $15?*"

Draft 2:

CATEGORY	COST
Popcorn supplies	$20
Drinks	$8 (water + small juice)
Decorations	$10 (paper, no balloons)
Movie rental	$10
Total	**$48** (under by $2)

Coach: "*That's a real budget. You made a tradeoff — fewer balloons, smaller drinks. That's what budgeting is.*"

Worked example B — Overrun by a lot ($95 → $50)

Draft 1 for a school art fair:

CATEGORY	COST
Canvas + paint	$40
Frames	$25
Snacks	$15
Sign printing	$15
Total	**$95** (over by $45)

Coach: "*This is over by 90%. The plan doesn't fit the budget. Can the art fair happen with no frames? Could parents lend frames? What's negotiable?*"

Draft 2:

CATEGORY	COST
Canvas + paint	$30 (smaller canvases)
Frames	$0 (parents lend)
Snacks	$10
Sign printing	$10 (one large sign, not five)
Total	**$50** (exactly under cap)

Worked example C — Already under the cap ($35) — what's the move?
Coach: "*You're under cap! Now what? Could you spend the extra $15 on something that makes the event better? Should you save it as a buffer for surprises?*" Both are valid answers. Surface the choice.

Common Misconceptions (Grade 4)

KID BELIEF	WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE	HOW TO COACH
"A budget is a wish list."	A budget is a promise to yourself about a number. A wish list says what you want. A budget says what you'll pay.	"*What's the difference between wanting a $100 cake and saying you'll spend $100 on a cake? The second is a budget; the first is a wish.*"
"If I plan it, it'll happen exactly that way."	Plans always meet reality. Plans change. The point is to know which way they change and why.	"*Tell me one thing you planned this week that didn't go as planned. What happened? What did you do?*"
"A 'customer' is everyone."	A customer is a specific group of people you can describe. "*Everyone in school*" is not a customer. "*Third graders who get hungry between recess and lunch*" is.	"*If your customer is everyone, name three customers who are NOT your target. If you can't, you don't have a target yet.*"
"Profit doesn't matter as long as the sale happens."	Profit is what's left after costs. A sale with negative profit is a sale you lose money on.	"*If you sell a cookie for $1 that cost you $1.20 to make, did you win or lose?*"

Customer-statement worked examples (add to Lesson 5)

Six worked examples of the 1-sentence customer statement format: "*This is for [who] who needs [what].*"

1. **Service:** "This dog-walking service is for **busy parents in our neighborhood** who need **a kid to walk their dog after school on weekdays.**"
2. **Product:** "This bracelet is for **9-year-olds** who need **a way to remember their best friend's birthday.**"

3. **Event:** "This Spring Carnival is for **families with kids in our school** who need **a fun afternoon together that supports the PTA fund.**"
4. **Content:** "This zine is for **third- and fourth-graders** who need **comics that are funny without being mean.**"
5. **Repair:** "This pencil-fixing booth is for **classmates** who need **a sharpened pencil before class starts.**"
6. **Tutoring:** "This after-school math help is for **second-graders who are starting multiplication** who need **older-kid help with the times tables.**"

Coach: each customer statement is specific. "*Everyone who likes dogs*" is not specific. "*Busy parents in our neighborhood*" is.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Grade 4)

COMMON KID-BELIEF	REALITY	COACHING MOVE
"A budget is a wish list."	A budget is a *plan* that fits within a *limit*. The numbers add up to a fixed total.	Show two papers: a wish list ("I want everything!") vs. a budget ("$50 cap, 4 categories, totals to exactly $50"). Have students mark which is which.
"If I plan something once, the plan is done."	A plan changes as reality hits. Real entrepreneurs revise plans at least once. The before/after diff is the artifact.	Show a Cash story where the entrepreneurs Plan A failed and Plan B worked. Have students circle the changes.
"The customer statement is for me to feel good about my idea."	The customer statement is for the *customer* — to clarify whom the business helps and what frustration it addresses.	Run 6 worked examples spanning service / product / event / content. Have students score: "Does the customer recognize themselves?"
"Cost only includes the things I bought."	Cost includes time, supplies, transportation, packaging — anything you spent or used.	Walk through a lemonade event budget that *forgets* the cups (and the lemons cant be served without cups). Force the fix.
"If I forgot something in my budget, I just add money."	If youre at the cap, adding money requires *cutting somewhere else*. Budgets force trade-offs.	Show 3 draft budgets that miss the $50 cap (over by $5, under by $10, exactly correct). Have students identify the fixes for each.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Worked Examples for the $50 Event Budget Lesson

Class is throwing a Spring Carnival snack station. Cap: $50. Categories: snacks, drinks, supplies, signage.

Draft Budget A (over by $5). - Snacks $25, Drinks $15, Supplies $10, Signage $5. Total = $55. Over $5. - Coaching: "Where can we cut $5? Could we make signs by hand instead of printing? That saves $5. New total = $50."

Draft Budget B (under by $10). - Snacks $15, Drinks $10, Supplies $10, Signage $5. Total = $40. Under $10. - Coaching: "We have $10 unused. Could we *increase* snack quality? Could we *save* the $10 for next event? Both are fine. The student should *decide*, not leave money idle."

Draft Budget C (exactly $50). - Snacks $20, Drinks $15, Supplies $10, Signage $5. Total = $50. Exactly $50. - Coaching: "This is on cap. Now ask — are the *categories* right? Did we forget anything? (Bags? Tape? Permission slips?)"

Anti-example. Student writes "Snacks $50" and stops. Coaching: "Cap reached on one line. But will customers want *just* snacks, with no drinks or signs? Lets re-allocate."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Multi-Class Branching Scenario (Grade 4)

"Spring Carnival, $50, three options for the snack station." A 3-day branching scenario.

- **Day 1.** The class is running the snack station for Spring Carnival. They have $50. Three options: (a) cookies (low cost, low margin), (b) lemonade (medium cost, medium margin), (c) hot pretzels (high cost, high margin). Brainstorm pros and cons. Run 5-question Reality Check on each.

- **Day 2.** Class votes. Build the chosen options 1-page plan: idea, customer, price, costs, plan. Make a $50-cap budget that adds to exactly $50.
- **Day 3.** "What if it rains?" Revise the plan. Circle three changes. This is the before/after diff artifact.

This branching practices BAVC (read business profile of a snack station), PSIG (5 ideas + Reality Check), MFL ($50 cap budget), CBM (1-sentence customer statement), OSO (1-page plan), LTO (5-minute team meeting), ESL (kid-business rules: did anyone have permission?), LRCI (before/after plan diff).

ROUND 2 PATCH — Six Worked Examples for the 1-Sentence Customer Statement Lesson

The form: "This is for [customer] who needs [need]."

1. **Service:** "This is for second-graders who lose their pencils so often they cant do morning work." Strong: specific customer + specific frustration.
2. **Product:** "This is for kids whose hot lunch gets cold by the time they sit down." Strong: specific event + specific consequence.
3. **Event:** "This is for fifth-graders whose families dont know how to celebrate the end of the year together." Caution: "families" is vague — sharpen to "fifth-graders who want a low-cost end-of-year party."
4. **Content:** "This is for new sixth-graders who are scared of getting lost in the new building." Strong: emotion + specific context.
5. **Tutoring service:** "This is for third-graders who can do the math but cant write the answers neatly enough." Strong: specific gap.
6. **Lost-and-Found locator:** "This is for kids who lost something in the past week and cant remember where to look." Strong: time-bounded + specific frustration.

Anti-example: "This is for kids who like things." Coaching: "Whos the *kid*? What do they *want*?"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Grade 4)

- **Student wants to throw a real birthday party with a real $50.** Say: "Lets practice the budget here. Then talk to your family at home about whether they want to do it for real. The budget skill is the same either way."
- **Student leaves a category off the budget.** Say: "If a customer walked up, would you have what they need? What did you forget?"
- **Student writes a customer statement that names *no one*** ("This is for everyone"). Say: "Lets pick *one* person. Whos the *most* likely customer?" Use the 5-question Reality Check.
- **Student insists their plan doesnt need revision.** Say: "Real entrepreneurs revise. Lets find one thing — even a small one — youd change. What if the weather changed? What if half your customers didnt show?"
- **Student runs a 5-minute meeting that takes 20 minutes.** Say: "5 minutes means 5 minutes. Whats the *first* item on the agenda? *Last week.* Two minutes. *This week.* Two minutes. *Blockers.* One minute. Done."

FROM CASH

A plan is five honest answers

Who is it for? What is it? Why now? How much? How will I know it worked? Five lines. One page. Done.

KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 4 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Income - earning, planning, and tradeoffs.

CEE NS5
Roles of producers, consumers, and decisions.

CCSS-MATH 4.OA
Operations and algebraic thinking - model word problems.

CCSS-ELA W.4.2
Write to inform and explain - one-page plan.

CASEL Responsible Decision-Making
Identify problems, analyze situations.

C3 D2.Eco.2.3-5
Identify positive and negative incentives.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one.*"

- CASH, GRADE 4

A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one. — Cash

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